

# PERFORMANCE EVALUATION OF A SECURED BLE MESH NETWORK

## 1. Development Environment Setup

### 1.1 Installed Required Tools

nRF Connect for Desktop

Official tool for Nordic development.

<https://www.nordicsemi.com/Products/Development-tools/nRF-Connect-for-desktop>

### Installed the following applications:

Toolchain Manager

Programmer

Serial Terminal

Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE)

### J-Link Driver

Required for flashing and debugging Nordic boards.

<https://www.segger.com/downloads/jlink>

### Visual Studio Code

Code editor for development.

<https://code.visualstudio.com/>

### nRF Connect for VS Code Extension

Installed extension inside VS Code for:

Build

Flash

Debug

SDK management

<https://www.nordicsemi.com/Products/Development-tools/nRF-Connect-for-VS-Code>

### Installed nRF Connect SDK (v2.9+)

Using Toolchain Manager, installed:

nRF Connect SDK v2.9.2

Compatible toolchain

## **2. Initial Board Testing**

### **2.1 Blinky Test**

**Created first project: Blinky**

**Verified:**

Board power supply

GPIO functionality

Build & flash working

Toolchain configured properly

This confirmed hardware and environment were correctly set up.

## **3. BLE Communication Testing**

### **3.1 Kit-to-Kit Communication**

**Configured:**

One board as Peripheral

Second board as Central

**Verified:**

Successful BLE connection

Data transfer between two nRF5340 DK boards

### **3.2 Mobile-to-Board Communication**

**Used nRF Connect mobile app:**

□ Android: <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=no.nordicsemi.android.mcp> □

iOS: <https://apps.apple.com/app/nrf-connect/id1054362403>

**Tested:**

BLE advertising

Connecting to peripheral

Sending and receiving data

Confirmed BLE stack working correctly.

## **4. Hardware Integration**

### **4.1 I2C 16x2 LCD Integration (Central Side)**

**Connected:**

16x2 LCD with I2C module

Used I2C (TWI) peripheral

**Verified LCD working using test program:**

(HELLO NITESH )

**This confirmed:**

I2C configuration correct

SDA/SCL mapping correct

Power supply stable

Display functioning properly

#### 4.2 4x4 Matrix Keypad Integration (Peripheral Side)

**Connected:**

4 Row pins

4 Column pins

Configured GPIO scanning logic

**Implemented:**

Row scanning

Column detection

Debounce handling

**Verified:**

Correct key detection

Key value printing via UART

Keypad data sent over BLE

#### 5. BLE Data Transmission from Keypad to LCD

**System Design:**

Peripheral (Keypad)



BLE Transmission



Central (LCD Display)

**Working:**

Key pressed on keypad

Sent via BLE

Displayed on LCD in real time

**This demonstrated:**

BLE NUS Service implementation

GATT communication

Real-time wireless data transfer

**6. Secure PIN Authentication Implementation****Extended project to create:****❑ Secure PIN-Based Access System Logic:**

User enters PIN via keypad

PIN sent over BLE

Central device verifies PIN

**LCD displays:****If incorrect:**

**WRONG PIN**

**If correct:**

**HELLO**

**7. Real-World Applications****This system can be applied in:**

Smart Door Lock Systems

ATM PIN Authentication

Digital Lockers

Access Control Systems

Smart Home Security

Secure IoT Devices

**8. Technical Concepts Used**

**Embedded Systems**

GPIO configuration

I2C communication

UART debugging

Interrupt handling

## **BLE Stack**

Peripheral role

Central role

GATT services

Nordic UART Service (NUS)

Secure pairing

## **RTOS Concepts (Zephyr)**

Threads

Work queue

Heap memory

Kconfig configuration

## **Debugging**

Build errors

Devicetree issues

SDK compatibility fixes

Flash memory settings

## 9. **Project Architecture Summary**

### **Peripheral Device:**

4x4 Keypad

BLE Peripheral

Sends PIN

### **Central Device:**

BLE Central

16x2 LCD via I2C

PIN verification logic

Output display

#### 10. **Skills Demonstrated**

BLE protocol implementation  
Embedded C development  
Hardware interfacing  
Real-time debugging  
SDK migration handling  
System integration  
Secure authentication logic design

#### 11. **Project Difficulty Level**

Intermediate to Advanced Embedded IoT System

##### **Includes:**

Multi-device communication  
Wireless protocol  
Hardware integration  
Security logic implementation

#### 12. **Why This is a Strong Resume Project**

##### **Because it combines:**

BLE  
Security  
Embedded Hardware  
Real-world application  
Nordic SDK  
Zephyr RTOS

This is significantly better than a simple LED or UART project.

## Workflow of Secure BLE-Based PIN Authentication System

